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what fonts are used in Star Trek TNG Computers



The primary typeface used on the LCARS (Library Computer Access/Retrieval System) computer displays throughout *Star Trek: The Next Generation* is **Helvetica Ultra Compressed** (often associated with Swiss 911 Ultra Compressed), though early episodes in Season 1 used **Compacta Light**. Fandom +1



## Key TNG Computer Fonts

- **Helvetica Ultra Compressed:** The iconic, tall, and narrow sans-serif font used for the majority of the ship's operational readouts, status blocks, and LCARS UI panels from the middle of TNG through subsequent 90s series. Fandom
- **Compacta Light:** Used for the interface text during the early first-season episodes (such as "Encounter at Farpoint") before the production team transitioned permanently to Helvetica. Fandom
- **Crillie Italic:** The distinct sloping font used for the show's on-screen episodic credits and title treatments. Fandom +2

If you are designing an LCARS interface or theme, would you like recommendations on **free web/system fonts** (like Antonio or Oswald) that closely mimic Helvetica Ultra Compressed?

AI responses may include mistakes. [Learn more](#)



Ask anything





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Is there an accessible version of this font?

**Yes, there are several highly accessible and free alternatives** to Helvetica Ultra Compressed that you can use for digital projects, documents, or websites. Because the original commercial fonts like Linotype Helvetica Ultra Compressed require paid licenses, the design community frequently uses open-source lookalikes. [↗](#)

## Free Google Fonts Alternatives

These fonts are open-source, free for personal and commercial use, and optimized for digital readability: [↗](#)

- **Antonio:**
  - **Why it fits:** This is the closest free Google Font to the original LCARS aesthetic.
  - **Standout feature:** It is a dedicated, ultra-narrow sans-serif with a similarly tall geometric structure.
- **Oswald (Light or Regular):**
  - **Why it fits:** A highly popular, condensed font family available on Google Fonts.
  - **Standout feature:** Features a slightly wider structure than Antonio,





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Videos

Forums

More ▾



If you need exact replicas that include specialized Star Trek geometric shapes and UI symbols, the fan community has created dedicated options:

- **LCARS Font Family:** Free fan-created variations available on digital typography archives like DaFont or 1001 Fonts.
- **Swiss 911 Ultra Compressed:** Often pre-installed with certain core graphics software suites (like older versions of CorelDRAW) or bundled in online Star Trek asset packs.

Would you like help setting up the **CSS styling rules** (like letter-spacing and text-transform) to make these free fonts look exactly like the TNG computer screens?

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**Yes, there is an official, highly specific colour scheme** used for the LCARS computer system. Originally designed by scenic artist Mike Okuda for *Star Trek: The Next Generation*, the palette was intentionally limited to a few specific pastel and vibrant shades so that it wouldn't distract from the actors on camera. Fandom +3

The system relies on a **solid black background** (#000000), with interface elements (the "chrome") using the official hexadecimal color groupings listed below. Color Hex Color Codes +1

## The Classic TNG Era Palette (The "Okudagram" Yellows & Tans)

The early seasons of TNG relied heavily on warm earth tones, golds, and muted purples. Digital design archives like [The LCARS Color Guide](#) and data packages like [trekcolors](#) break down these specific hexadecimal values: GitHub +2

- **Neon Carrot / LCARS Orange:** #FF9933 — The classic bright operational button color.
- **Atomic Tangerine / Mango:** #FF9900 or #FF9966 — Used for structural panel headers.
- **Golden Tanoi / Beige:** #FFCC66 — The dominant background block shade for stable menus.
- **Pale Canary / Yellow:** #FFFF99 — Used for active text readouts and highlighted indicators.
- **Anakiwa / Light Blue:** #99CCFF — Frequently used for secondary telemetry readouts. Matthew Leonawicz +2

## The Voyager & Deep Space Nine Extensions (The Purples &





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mapping elements.

- **Chestnut Rose / Brick:** #CC6666 — A muted, dark red-pink used for inactive warnings or system limits. Matthew Leonawicz +2

## Emergency Protocols

When the ship changes operational states, the computer interface dynamically swaps its primary colors to communicate urgency: Fandom

- **Red Alert:** #CC0000 or #E7442a mixed with pure White ( #FFFFFF ). The entire screen flashes black-and-red to command visual attention.
- **Blue Alert:** #006699 or #37a6d1 mixed with White. Used during environmental operations (like landing the USS *Voyager*). Fandom

Are you building a **web interface** or a **home automation dashboard** (like Home Assistant)? I can provide a pre-made CSS variable theme snippet based on these exact hexadecimal codes.

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Forums

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A small black plus sign icon, used for adding content or opening a menu.

A small black microphone icon, used for voice search.